The People and Instructions Behind Your Mother's Week, in One Place

A one-page inventory of the names, numbers and written instructions the family already has, and the ones nobody has.

The neighbor's number is in your sister's phone, the pharmacy's is on a pill bottle, and the note from the doctor's office is somewhere in the kitchen.

This page doesn't ask you to understand or judge any of it. It asks where each thing is, how recent it is, and who has it.

WHAT TO COLLECT	WHERE IT IS	ITS DATE	WHO HAS IT
Names and phone numbers for everyone with a regular day: your sister, the neighbor, anyone else			
Names and phone numbers for anyone who has said they could cover			
Her doctor's office: name and phone number			
Her pharmacy: name and phone number			
Any other professional she sees regularly			
Written instructions from her doctor or another professional			
Her medication list, if one is written down			
The family's own page of who helps and when, if there is one			
Notes anyone has kept on things they've noticed			

What's missing, and who will ask for it

Anything above with an empty line. Put a name next to each.

FOR EXAMPLE Only my sister has the neighbor's number. She'll send it to the rest of us. Nobody knows whether there's a written medication list; I'll ask her on Sunday.

How to use it

- Ask your mother first. It's her doctor, her pharmacy and her neighbor, and she decides what gets shared and with whom.

- For a phone number, the date is when someone last used it. For a paper, it's the date printed on it. If there isn't one, write “undated.”
- Don't copy out or summarize an instruction here. Just say where it is.
- Keep the page somewhere the family can find it, and tell everyone where that is.

What this page doesn't do

It doesn't explain what any instruction means or whether it still applies. If something you find isn't clear, that's a question for the person who wrote it.

Ready for the next step?

You know where the names, the numbers and the written instructions are, and which ones nobody has. The care interview puts them to use: it walks you through your mother's situation area by area and turns your answers into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›

WHERE THIS COMES FROM

The rows for her doctors' contact details and her medication list follow what the CDC says a written care plan should include. The rest come from the Family Care Roadmap's working list for this step.

1. Centers for Disease Control and Prevention, Steps for Creating and Maintaining a Care Plan